

Bible Study Lesson 1

Reading Scripture in context

How many books are in the Bible? 66 (39 OT & 27 NT)

Please note that the books are not placed in chronological order. Within each book there is a timeframe reference based on the social and cultural reference of events that were taking place at that point in time. For example:

The COVID time period.

Biblical examples

The book of **Genesis** starts with “In the beginning” indicating the beginning of creation.

The book of **Isaiah** starts with, “The vision of Isaiah, the son of Amoz, which he saw concerning Judah & Jerusalem, in the days of Uzziah, Jotham, Ahaz, and Hezekiah, kings of Judah,” indicating the period of the Divided Kingdom.

The book of **Judges** begins with, “Now after the death of Joshua, it came to pass, that the children of Israel asked the Lord, saying who shall go up for us against the Canaanite first to fight against them,” indicating the time period after Joshua’s death.

Culture and society

In addition to various timeframe references to gain a better understanding of scripture, we can also use cultural examples and social positions. In doing so you are able to gain a more informed perspective from being able to see things from that culture or society’s point of view.

The major sections of the Bible

So in learning how to study, we also need to know how many sections are in the Bible? **8 (4 OT & 4 NT)**

Old Testament

The Old Testament tells the story of creation and the history of ancient Israel. It is split into four main groups:

- 1. The Pentateuch (Law):** Genesis through Deuteronomy. These five books cover creation, early human history, and the laws of Moses.
- 2. Historical Books:** Joshua through Esther. These 12 books trace Israel's history, the kings, and the Babylonian exile.
- 3. Poetry and Wisdom:** Job through Song of Solomon. These 5 books offer songs, prayers, and practical wisdom for daily life.
- 4. Prophetic Books:** Isaiah through Malachi. These 17 books contain messages from God warning people to turn back to Him and promising future restoration.

New Testament

The New Testament focuses on the life of Jesus Christ and the start of the Christian church. It is split into four main groups:

- 1. The Gospels:** Matthew, Mark, Luke, and John. These four books share the life, teachings, death, and resurrection of Jesus.
- 2. Church History:** Acts of the Apostles. This book records how the early Christian church began and spread.
- 3. The Epistles (Letters):** Romans through Jude. Letters written by church leaders like Paul to guide early believers.
- 4. Prophecy:** Revelation. This final book uses visions to describe spiritual realities and the end times.

Questions from the people